

Physician Engagement Strategy

Building Medical Director Relationships

UNDERSTANDING PHYSICIAN PRIORITIES

Physicians have unique concerns that require a tailored approach:

- Time efficiency is their most valuable resource
- Clinical outcomes and evidence-based care drive decisions
- They need clear, actionable communication
- Peer credibility matters more than sales presentations

THE PHYSICIAN SALES MASTERY APPROACH

Stage 1: Discovery with Physicians

Focus on understanding their practice patterns and patient population:

"Dr. [Name], I work with physicians who manage patients with serious illness. I'm curious about your experience - when patients reach end-stage disease, what typically happens with their care transitions?"

Stage 2: Connecting with Physicians

Build relationship through clinical credibility:

- Share relevant clinical research and outcomes data
- Offer CME opportunities on palliative care topics
- Introduce them to your medical director for peer consultation
- Demonstrate knowledge of their specialty-specific challenges

Stage 3: Guiding Physicians

Present solutions in clinical terms:

- Focus on patient outcomes and quality of life metrics
- Show how hospice extends their care rather than replacing it
- Provide clear criteria for when to consider hospice referral
- Offer streamlined referral processes that save time

Stage 4: Commitment from Physicians

Make partnering easy and low-risk:

- Start with a single patient trial rather than formal partnership
- Provide excellent follow-up communication on that first patient
- Gradually build to regular referral patterns

CME PARTNERSHIP OPPORTUNITIES

Offer educational value to physicians through:

- Lunch-and-learn sessions on hospice eligibility criteria
- Grand rounds presentations on symptom management
- Case conferences on complex patients
- Written CME materials on end-of-life care

PHYSICIAN RELATIONSHIP RULE

Never waste a physician's time. Be prepared, be brief, be clinical. If you can't articulate your value in 30 seconds, you're not ready for the meeting.